LIGHTING SPARKS OF INNOVATION

Education at the institute is about devising solutions that have the social reality of the country firmly at their centre

By M.G. Arun

As Prof. Varun Nagaraj, dean of the S.P. Jain Institute of Management and Research (SPJIMR), appears for an interaction in his office at the institute's sprawling campus in Andheri, Mumbai, one cannot help but notice a striking blue plaque that's fixed on the wall behind him, which states its vision—to be recognised globally as an innovative and socially-conscious management school. And these are the twin guiding stars—innovation and social awareness—that the 43-year-old institute has kept in its sights while framing its programmes chiefly around them, so that they give students a comprehensive exposure to academics as well as the environment they are living in, helping them better cope with the rising demands of the world of business.

SPJIMR's flagship programme, the two-year post-graduate diploma in management (PGDM), focuses on four specialisations—Finance, Operations, Marketing, and Information Management and Analytics. "However, we noticed that the nature of problem-solving was changing to a point where industry was looking for those with more integrated skills," says Nagaraj. For the past two years, therefore, SPJIMR has included 'general management' in its bouquet of specialisations.

Pivoting to another need, the institute has begun an online version of the PGDM, accredited by the All India Council for Technical Education. "What we discovered is that there is a largely untapped market of those with five and ten years of working experience who want education from a first-class institution but are not ready to let go of

TOP 10 PRIVATE B-SCHOOLS

RANK	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY
1	S.P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH	Mumbai
2	MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE, GURGAON	Gurugram
3	SVKM'S NMIMS, SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	Mumbai
4	INTERNATIONAL MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE, NEW DELHI	New Delhi
5	INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT TECHNOLOGY, GHAZIABAD	Ghaziabad
6	SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT, PUNE	Pune
7	SYMBIOSIS CENTRE FOR MANAGEMENT & HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT	Pune
8	GREAT LAKES INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT	Chennai
9	XAVIER INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT	Bhubaneswar
10	T.A. PAI MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE, MANIPAL	Manipal



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